

A 90-minute stage play typically translates to approximately 90–100 pages of script and often utilizes a three-act structure.

Below is a detailed scene-by-scene outline for *Horseshoe Girl and Hermit Boy*, designed to meet a 90-minute run time.

Horseshoe Girl and Hermit Boy: A 90-Minute Stage Play Outline

ACT I: The Awkward Shell (30 Minutes)

Act I focuses on establishing the characters' initial conflicts, the setting, and introducing the catalyst for the main journey.

Scene	Time (Est.)	Location	Key Events
I.1	5 min	Portland International Jetport/Tran Family SUV	August 2018. Cát Lý arrives, feeling displaced that she's hosted by an Asian family. The awkward ride to Bangor. We meet Eric (stoic) and Sybil (distracted engineer).
I.2	5 min	Tran House - Living Room/Cát's Room	Initial settling in. Cát expresses frustration in a private moment/monologue about not fitting in. Morgan is introduced as solitary, wearing his Nautilus shell necklace .
I.3	10 min	Various Bangor Locations (High School/Diner)	The teens navigate the awkward social landscape of small-town Maine. Vibe is chilly. Cát is intense about arthropods; Morgan is withdrawn.
I.4	8 min	Bagaduce River Shoreline	The visit to the river. Morgan finds the horseshoe crab shell as a peace offering. They discuss the natural world. Tense moment when news breaks about the September 28th Indonesian tsunami . Morgan pulls away, sealing himself off (becoming a "hermit").

I.5	2 min	Tran House - Morgan's Room (Brief)	Morgan retreats fully. Cát observes his isolation, wishing they could both find a home.
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ACT II: The Cursed Currents (40 Minutes)

Act II is the core action sequence, where the magical journey takes over, driven by the race against time.

Scene	Time (Est.)	Location	Key Events
II.1	5 min	Tran House - Living Room/Parents' absence	October 23rd. The early snowstorm hits. Parents are trapped at the Bath Iron Works christening. Cát discovers Morgan's abandoned nautilus necklace.
II.2	3 min	Tran House - Cát's Room/Transformation Reveal	Cát picks up the necklace. It pulses. She finds Morgan as a hermit crab. The horseshoe crab spirit (Bagaduce) manifests from the shell, revealing the curse and the time limit: one day to reach Relic Island .
II.3	10 min	Pet Store	The "makeover montage." They seek shells that fit the growing Morgan. A fabulous, understanding employee helps them. Morgan physically sizes up, finding his fashion and shedding old restrictions. (A high-energy, comedic scene.)
II.4	8 min	Maine Maritime Academy / Historian's Office	They seek guidance from a local historian. They use a map to mark historical trading spots and the dangerous routes to the islands. Exposition about local lore and the lighthouse.
II.5	10 min	Open Water - Bagaduce River Estuary	Cát rents a weathered boat and rows. Bagaduce pushes them into risky, treacherous waters. The teens fight over the danger. A sudden hailstorm capsizes the boat.

II.6	4 min	Water (VFX/Staging moment)	Morgan floats, but Cát resurfaces as a horseshoe crab. To save Cát, Bagaduce traps her soul in the shell. Both are now arthropods, at the mercy of the current.
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ACT III: The Light of Home (20 Minutes)

Act III brings the climax, resolution, and epilogue. The pacing speeds up for the emotional peak.

Scene	Time (Est.)	Location	Key Events
III.1	5 min	Relic Island Shoreline/Lighthouse Base	They wash up on the island. Defeated, they reach the empty lighthouse. They activate the light, which summons ethereal horseshoe crab spirits who reject the outcast Bagaduce.
III.2	5 min	Lighthouse Interior/Astral Plane (Staging Shift)	Morgan accepts his fate and finally wears the Nautilus shell as his "perfect fit." This sends him into a beautiful astral sequence where he briefly reunites with his birth family. The "light" transforms from a physical beacon to an emotional truth.
III.3	3 min	Relic Island Shoreline/Lighthouse Base	They wake up, human again. The "light stronger than moonlight" was the shelter of loved ones/found family, not a literal beacon. The lighthouse beam signals the Coast Guard.
III.4	4 min	Tran House - Living Room (Later that night)	The rescue and emotional return home. The parents rush in. A moment of poignant reconciliation and understanding between Cát, Morgan, and the adoptive parents. The family bond is solidified.

III.5	3 min	Various locations/Montage (Epilogue)	Halloween: Teens dress up as their anthropods. Cát goes back to Vietnam for the holidays. Flashforward to 2026: A brief tableau showing their lifelong connection and the birth of their daughter, Arcadia.
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